The One Problem With Star Wars, According to Andy Weir

From: /Film Mined: 2026-11-02 5 min read

Everyone has an opinion about Star Wars, including science-fiction author Andy Weir, who wrote "The Martian" and "Project Hail Mary." In a recent conversation, he shared what he would do if he were in charge of Star Wars.

His main concern is massive **upheaval**. "Star Wars is more about massive **upheaval**," he said. "One problem that happens is, if you're going to have a story about a **monumental** war, then when it's over and the good guys win, you want it to stay that way. So it's very unsatisfying if you roll into a new **monumental** war."

That criticism will sound familiar to fans of "The Force Awakens" from 2015: some viewers were uneasy that the original heroes' victory seemed undone, with the Empire and Rebellion effectively replaced by the First Order and Resistance.

Weir's suggestion looks back to "Rogue One," from nearly a decade ago. "I feel like the best way, in my opinion, to do another Star Wars movie," he said, "would be to have the story of other people during the Galactic Civil War." Luke Skywalker, Leia Organa and Han Solo were the movers and shakers of "A New Hope" and beyond, he acknowledged, but there is room for smaller, **tangential** stories alongside theirs.

"Think of it like this: We know what happened in World War II, but there are some really good fictional stories that take place during World War II," he said. "So if you treat the Galactic Civil War as established **canon**, there's still a lot of stories to tell about other people living through those wars."

Weir also praised "Andor," the Disney+ **prequel** series from Tony Gilroy, calling it amazing and really good, but said a series was the correct choice: a movie must tell its whole story in about two hours, while "Andor" was intellectual and clever.

Word Treasure

upheaval -- A big, sudden change that shakes things up.
monumental -- Huge and very important.
tangential -- Stories on the side of the main story.
canon -- The official events of a story world.
prequel -- A story set before an earlier story.

Background you need

Star Wars is a famous space story about a struggle between good and evil across a galaxy.

The Galactic Civil War is the war between the Rebellion and the Empire in Star Wars.

A prequel tells a story that happens before an earlier story.

Rogue One is a Star Wars movie about other characters during that war.

Break it down

LEAD: Andy Weir's one problem with Star Wars
KEY EVENT: A war that is won should stay won
+- QUOTE: Star Wars is about massive upheaval
+- EXAMPLE: The Force Awakens replaced the Empire and Rebellion
+- FIX: Tell stories of other people during the Galactic Civil War
ANALOGY: Like World War II stories about people living through a known war
ANDOR: A series was the correct choice; a movie must fit about two hours

Why it matters

How a story handles victory shapes whether fans trust it, and Weir's idea shows that small stories inside a big war can matter as much as the main heroes'.

Test what you remember

1. Who is Andy Weir?

- (A) Director of Andor
- (B) Author of The Martian and Project Hail Mary
- (C) Director of Rogue One
- (D) Creator of Star Wars

2. What is Weir's main concern?

- (A) Andor was a series
- (B) Movies are too long
- (C) Too many small stories
- (D) Starting a new monumental war after the good guys win

3. Which movie does Weir point to as a model?

- (A) Rogue One
- (B) The Force Awakens
- (C) A New Hope
- (D) Andor

4. What comparison does Weir use for his idea?

- (A) Project Hail Mary
- (B) The Galactic Civil War
- (C) The Martian
- (D) World War II

5. What did Weir say about Andor's format?

- (A) It was boring
- (B) It was too short
- (C) It should have been a movie
- (D) A series was the correct choice

6. Who were the movers and shakers of A New Hope and beyond?

- (A) Tony Gilroy
- (B) Luke Skywalker, Leia Organa and Han Solo
- (C) The First Order and the Resistance
- (D) Other people during the Galactic Civil War

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: D 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Andy Weir: Star Wars should tell smaller stories of other people during the Galactic Civil War instead of starting a new monumental war.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):